

UX-0001 — Butlerly Experience Blueprint

Version 1.0

Document Status

Owner: Butlerly Product & Design

Applies To: Butlerly Version 1

Purpose: Define the intended end-to-end product experience before wireframes, visual design, and implementation.

1. Vision and Purpose

Butlerly is a local-first, privacy-first personal life assistant. Its first product experience focuses on helping individuals capture, organize, understand, and retrieve their financial information without surrendering control of their data or learning accounting terminology.

This blueprint defines how Butlerly should feel and behave. It is not a feature list, a wireframe specification, or a technical architecture. It is the experience-level authority that guides later decisions in user journeys, information architecture, interaction design, visual design, AI behavior, accessibility, and engineering.

The Version 1 experience should create a simple promise:

“Your financial life is organized, understandable, and under your control.”

Butlerly should not feel like bookkeeping software, a bank dashboard, or a generic AI chat interface. It should feel like a trusted personal assistant that quietly does the routine work, explains what it understands, asks only when necessary, and leaves the user in control.

2. Experience North Star

The North Star experience is:

A user can capture or import financial information, allow Butlerly to organize it locally, review only the items that genuinely need attention, and later retrieve or understand the information within seconds.

The ideal flow is:

Capture → Understand → Review Exceptions → Confirm → Organize → Retrieve → Learn

The product should minimize repeated data entry, unnecessary decisions, unexplained automation, and navigation between disconnected modules.

A successful Butlerly experience is not measured by how many screens or features are available. It is measured by how little effort is required for the user to remain informed and in control.

3. Target User

The primary Version 1 user is an individual who wants better control over personal financial records but does not want to become an accountant, financial analyst, or system administrator.

This user may:

- Have receipts, transactions, statements, subscriptions, and account records spread across many sources.
- Feel uncertain about where information is stored or how online services use it.
- Want help organizing information without uploading their entire financial life to a third party.
- Avoid traditional finance applications because they are too complex, too invasive, or too demanding.
- Want quick answers such as “What was this charge?”, “Where is that receipt?”, or “How much did I spend on this?”
- Prefer the assistant to do routine work but still expect to approve important changes.

The user is not defined by financial expertise. Butlerly should support a first-time finance app user without limiting more advanced users.

4. Desired Emotional Experience

Butlerly should intentionally create five emotional outcomes.

4.1 Safe

The user should understand where data is stored, what leaves the device, and when an external service is used. Privacy must be visible through understandable choices and behavior, not only through policy text.

4.2 Calm

The interface should reduce anxiety. It should not overwhelm users with alerts, charts, categories, configuration choices, or warnings. The product should distinguish between information that is useful now and information that can remain in the background.

4.3 Capable

The user should feel that Butlerly is doing meaningful work on their behalf. Captured information should become organized and searchable with minimal manual effort.

4.4 In Control

The user must be able to inspect, correct, undo, export, and delete. Automation should never make the user feel trapped or uncertain about what happened.

4.5 Progressing

Each interaction should leave the user's financial information cleaner, more complete, or easier to understand. The product should communicate progress without gamifying sensitive financial behavior.

5. Core Experience Principles

5.1 Privacy Is Part of the Interface

Privacy should be experienced, not hidden in settings.

The product should:

- Clearly distinguish local processing from optional external processing.
- Ask for consent at the point where data may leave the device.
- Explain why a permission or connection is needed.
- Avoid dark patterns that pressure users toward cloud services.
- Make export and deletion easy to find.
- Never use private financial data for advertising.

Design implication: privacy indicators should be calm and contextual. They should not become constant technical badges that add noise to every screen.

5.2 Local First, Not Local Only

The default experience should continue to function with local data and local intelligence whenever practical. Optional connected services may add convenience, synchronization, enrichment, or stronger AI capabilities, but the product must not make the user feel that local mode is a degraded trial.

Design implication: features should communicate capability differences honestly. "Processed on this device" and "Uses an external provider" are clearer than technical infrastructure language.

5.3 AI First, Manual Always Available

Butlerly should attempt the routine work first: extraction, categorization, merchant recognition, duplicate detection, linking, summarization, and search assistance.

The user should not be forced to complete a blank form when Butlerly can propose an answer.

At the same time:

- Every important AI suggestion must be editable.
- Manual entry must remain available.
- AI failure must not block the task.
- The product must not pretend confidence that it does not have.

5.4 Review Exceptions, Not Everything

The system should handle high-confidence, reversible work quietly and surface only meaningful exceptions.

The review queue should prioritize:

- Low-confidence interpretations.
- Possible duplicates.
- Missing or conflicting information.
- Unusual or consequential changes.
- Items requiring user consent.
- Failed imports or connections.

Design implication: Butlerly should avoid training users to approve every item. Repetitive confirmation destroys trust and turns automation into clerical work.

5.5 Explain Without Overexplaining

The user should be able to understand why Butlerly made a suggestion.

A useful explanation includes:

- What Butlerly believes.
- The evidence used.
- The confidence level.
- What the user can do next.

Example:

"I categorized this as Groceries because previous Costco purchases were categorized that way.
Confidence: High."

The default explanation should be brief. More detail should be available on demand.

5.6 Ask One Good Question

When clarification is required, Butlerly should ask the smallest question that resolves the uncertainty.

Poor:

"Please complete merchant, account, category, date, tax, location, payment type, and notes."

Better:

"Was this Costco purchase for groceries or household supplies?"

Questions should:

- Be specific.
- Provide likely options.
- Explain why the answer matters when not obvious.
- Avoid repeating information the system already knows.

5.7 Undo Is a First-Class Feature

Any reversible automated or manual change should support undo. Users should not fear trying a suggestion.

The product should maintain an understandable activity history for meaningful changes without exposing an engineering-style audit log as the default experience.

5.8 Progressive Disclosure

The interface should show the simplest useful view first and reveal advanced detail only when needed.

A new user should not have to understand:

- Accounting fields.
- Data schemas.
- AI providers.
- Synchronization models.
- Confidence scoring mathematics.
- Import implementation details.

Advanced users should still be able to inspect and control these areas.

5.9 Use Human Language

Butlerly should speak in terms users recognize:

- "Needs review," not "validation exception."
- "Money in" and "money out" where appropriate, not unexplained debit and credit terminology.
- "Receipt," "purchase," "refund," and "transfer," not database entity names.
- "Butlerly is unsure," not "classification threshold failure."

5.10 Every Screen Has a Clear Next Step

A screen should answer at least one of these questions:

- What happened?
- What needs my attention?
- What can I do here?
- What should I do next?
- How do I get back?

Empty states should teach rather than merely announce that no data exists.

6. Product Personality

Butlerly should be:

Trustworthy — precise, transparent, and consistent.

Quiet — helpful without constant interruption.

Competent — proactive with routine work.

Respectful — never judgmental about spending or financial choices.

Plainspoken — clear language without finance or AI jargon.

Reassuring — mistakes are correctable and data remains controlled by the user.

Butlerly should not be:

- Cute at the expense of credibility.
- Overly conversational when the user is completing a task.
- Judgmental, moralizing, or alarming.
- Pretending to be a human financial advisor.
- Overconfident about incomplete information.
- Filled with celebratory animations for sensitive financial events.

7. Core Version 1 Experience

7.1 Entry and Onboarding

Onboarding should establish trust before requesting access.

The user should learn:

- What Butlerly helps with.
- What is stored locally.
- Which capabilities are optional.
- That the user can export or delete their information.
- That the product can be useful before connecting every account or service.

The recommended sequence is:

1. Welcome and core promise.

2. Local-first and privacy explanation.
3. Choose a starting method: capture a receipt, import a file, or explore with sample data.
4. Request only the permission needed for the chosen action.
5. Show immediate value.

Onboarding should avoid a long configuration wizard. Settings can be refined after the user experiences the core value.

7.2 Capture

Users should be able to add information through the most natural available source:

- Receipt photo or scan.
- File import.
- Manual entry.
- Supported account or notification connection when intentionally enabled.
- Share-to-Butlerly from another application in later iterations.

After capture, Butlerly should immediately acknowledge:

- What was received.
- Whether processing is local or external.
- Whether processing is complete.
- Whether user attention is needed.

7.3 Understand

Butlerly should extract and propose:

- Merchant or source.
- Amount.
- Date.
- Transaction type.
- Category.
- Account or payment source when inferable.
- Receipt-to-transaction relationship.
- Duplicate possibility.
- Useful notes or searchable terms.

The user should see the result, not the extraction machinery.

7.4 Review

Review should be organized by exception and consequence, not chronological clutter.

Each review item should answer:

- What Butlerly thinks happened.

- Why it needs attention.
- The recommended choice.
- Other reasonable options.
- What happens after confirmation.

The preferred interaction is one decision per item, with batch actions only when the items are truly similar and the action is reversible.

7.5 Organize

After confirmation, Butlerly should organize information without forcing the user to manage folders or taxonomies.

Organization should be supported through:

- Searchable structured fields.
- Categories and tags.
- Relationships between receipts, transactions, accounts, merchants, and documents.
- User-created labels when needed.
- Automatic suggestions based on learned preferences.

Folders may be offered as an optional mental model, but they should not be the only organization mechanism.

7.6 Retrieve

Retrieval is a core Version 1 outcome.

The user should be able to search naturally:

- “Costco receipt from last month.”
- “Hotel charges in Hawaii.”
- “What did I pay for the laptop?”
- “Show purchases over \$500.”
- “Why was this categorized as travel?”

Search results should make it easy to:

- Refine.
- Preview.
- Open the original record.
- See related records.
- Correct incorrect organization.

7.7 Understand and Learn

Butlerly may provide concise observations that help the user understand the information already captured.

Version 1 insights should be descriptive and evidence-based, such as:

- A recurring charge was detected.
- A receipt appears to be missing for a transaction.
- Two records may be duplicates.
- Spending at a merchant changed significantly.
- A category is inconsistent with past choices.

The product should avoid presenting regulated financial advice or unsupported predictions.

8. Core User Journey

Primary Journey: Capture and Recover a Receipt

Stage 1 — Need

The user receives or finds a receipt and wants to avoid losing it.

Stage 2 — Entry

The user opens Butlerly or invokes a quick capture action.

Stage 3 — Capture

The user photographs or imports the receipt.

Stage 4 — Processing

Butlerly extracts the information and displays a calm processing state. The interface communicates whether processing occurs locally.

Stage 5 — Decision

If confidence is high and no conflict exists, Butlerly files the item and offers undo.

If clarification is needed, Butlerly asks one focused question.

Stage 6 — Completion

The user sees a compact confirmation:

“Receipt saved and linked to your Costco purchase.”

Stage 7 — Later Retrieval

Weeks or months later, the user searches in natural language and finds the receipt, transaction, and related context within seconds.

Experience success criteria:

- The initial capture requires minimal typing.
- The user understands what Butlerly did.

- The user is not required to approve routine fields.
- The item can be corrected later.
- Retrieval does not depend on remembering a folder or exact filename.

9. Navigation Philosophy

Navigation should be based on user intent rather than internal data structures.

Recommended Version 1 primary areas:

Home

A calm overview of recent activity, pending attention, and the most useful next action.

Review

A unified queue for items requiring review, clarification, consent, or recovery.

Transactions

A browsable history of transactions, receipts, and related documents with filters and saved views.

Search

A primary product capability, available globally.

Assistant (optional, non-primary)

A contextual way to ask questions, explain records, and initiate supported actions when enabled.

Settings

Privacy, data storage, connections, AI providers, export, deletion, preferences, and advanced controls.

Navigation rules:

- Search should be reachable from anywhere.
- Capture should be a prominent global action.
- Review should show meaningful pending work, not marketing notifications.
- Assistant should preserve context when launched from a record.
- Settings should separate ordinary preferences from advanced technical controls.
- Mobile and desktop may use different navigation patterns while preserving the same information architecture.

10. Designing States, Not Only Screens

Each major screen must be designed for its relevant states.

Examples for a transaction or receipt detail:

- Processing.
- High-confidence complete.
- Low-confidence field.
- Missing receipt.
- Possible duplicate.
- Conflicting amount or date.
- Linked to another record.
- Connection unavailable.
- External AI consent required.
- Corrected by user.
- Deleted or restored.
- Offline.
- Error with recovery path.

Every state should define:

- What the user sees.
- What the user can do.
- What Butlerly explains.
- Whether the state blocks progress.
- How the user recovers.
- Whether undo is available.

A design is incomplete until the failure, uncertainty, empty, loading, offline, and permission states are considered.

11. AI Interaction Model

Butlerly's AI interaction should follow a consistent loop:

Observe → Propose → Explain → User Controls → Learn

Observe

Use available records, preferences, and context within the user's approved privacy boundaries.

Propose

Offer a likely interpretation or action rather than presenting a blank task.

Explain

Provide the minimum useful reason and confidence.

User Controls

Allow confirm, correct, reject, defer, undo, or inspect details as appropriate.

Learn

Use corrections to improve future behavior, with a visible option to prevent or reset learning.

AI confidence should be expressed in human terms:

- High — Butlerly can proceed when the action is reversible.
- Medium — Butlerly may proceed with visible confirmation or place the item in review depending on consequence.
- Low — Butlerly should ask a focused question or defer action.

Confidence must not be used as decoration. It should influence the interaction.

12. Notification and Attention Design

Butlerly should protect the user's attention.

Notifications are justified when:

- A user-requested process completed or failed.
- A time-sensitive action is needed.
- A suspected duplicate or security-relevant change has meaningful consequence.
- A recurring financial event changed unexpectedly.
- The user explicitly requested a reminder.

Notifications should not be used to:

- Manufacture engagement.
- Repeatedly announce routine successful processing.
- Promote unrelated features.
- Create anxiety with vague warnings.

Within the application, the Inbox is the preferred place for non-urgent attention.

13. Error and Recovery Design

Errors should explain:

- What failed.
- What was preserved.
- What the user can do next.
- Whether retrying may help.
- Whether data left the device.

Examples:

“Receipt text could not be read. The image is saved. Retake the photo or enter the amount manually.”

“Bank import is temporarily unavailable. Your existing records are unchanged.”

The user should never be left uncertain whether a failed action created a duplicate, lost data, or transmitted private information.

14. Accessibility and Inclusion

Butlerly should target WCAG 2.2 AA for supported interfaces.

Core requirements:

- Full keyboard navigation on desktop.
- Clear focus states.
- Screen-reader labels and logical reading order.
- Sufficient color contrast.
- No information conveyed by color alone.
- Text resizing without loss of function.
- Large touch targets.
- Reduced-motion support.
- Plain-language labels.
- Accessible charts with textual summaries when charts are introduced.
- Dates, currency, numbers, and terminology adapted to locale.

Accessibility should be part of component acceptance criteria, not a later audit.

15. Visual Design Direction

The visual language should communicate calm competence.

Recommended qualities:

- Spacious layouts.
- Strong typographic hierarchy.
- Limited use of color for meaning.
- Neutral surfaces with clear emphasis.
- Consistent spacing and alignment.
- Subtle motion that confirms state changes.
- Icons paired with labels where meaning may be ambiguous.
- Dark mode designed intentionally, not mechanically inverted.

The design should avoid:

- Dense banking dashboards.
- Excessive cards competing for attention.
- Decorative charts without decisions attached.
- Bright warning colors for normal uncertainty.
- AI sparkle icons on every automated feature.
- Overuse of gradients, glass effects, or novelty patterns that reduce trust.

16. Interaction Standards

Common interactions should be predictable.

Primary actions:

One clear primary action per task area.

Secondary actions:

Visible when frequently needed; otherwise placed in a consistent overflow menu.

Destructive actions:

Require clear labeling, consequence explanation, and confirmation when recovery is not possible.

Selection:

Use checkboxes for batch selection. Do not overload row clicks with hidden behavior.

Editing:

Support inline editing for simple fields and a focused detail view for complex changes.

Saving:

Prefer automatic saving with visible status and undo. Use explicit Save only when the user is composing or reviewing a set of changes that should be committed together.

Loading:

Use skeletons for predictable content and progress indicators for meaningful processing. Do not show indefinite spinners without context.

Keyboard:

Support standard shortcuts first. Product-specific shortcuts should be discoverable and optional.

17. Trust Boundaries

The interface must clearly distinguish among:

Local Data

Stored and processed on the user's device.

Synchronized Data

Encrypted and copied across user-approved devices or services.

Connected Source Data

Accessed from a bank, email, cloud drive, or other provider with permission.

External AI Processing

Sent to a selected provider for a specific capability.

The user should be able to inspect and change these boundaries in one privacy and data control area.

Butlerly should never imply that “AI” is a single invisible system. The experience should reveal external involvement when it materially affects privacy, cost, or capability.

18. Success Measures

Experience success should be evaluated through behavioral and qualitative evidence.

Core Version 1 measures:

- Time to first successful capture.
- Percentage of captured items completed without manual form entry.
- Percentage of items requiring review.
- Accuracy after user correction.
- Time to retrieve a known record.
- Review queue completion rate.
- Undo and correction frequency.
- Import failure recovery rate.
- User understanding of local versus external processing.
- User-reported trust and sense of control.

Guardrail measures:

- No increase in accidental deletion or silent data loss.
- No design pattern that obscures external data transfer.
- No reliance on notifications to create engagement.
- No major workflow that becomes unusable without AI.
- No accessibility regression in core journeys.

19. Version 1 Scope Boundaries

This blueprint supports the focused Version 1 experience.

Intentionally outside the initial design scope:

- Full accounting or double-entry bookkeeping.
- Tax preparation.
- Investment management or trading.
- Credit scoring.
- Lending recommendations.
- Complex family or business collaboration.

- Marketplace or advertising experiences.
- Fully autonomous financial actions.
- Broad Life OS modules unrelated to the selected MVP.
- Advanced forecasting presented as certainty.
- Password management, despite its relevance to the long-term Life OS vision.

These areas may influence extensibility but must not complicate the Version 1 experience.

20. Design Decision Test

Every significant UX decision should pass the following questions:

1. Does it reduce effort for the primary user?
2. Does it preserve or increase user control?
3. Is the privacy behavior understandable?
4. Does Butlerly use available intelligence before asking the user?
5. Is uncertainty communicated honestly?
6. Can the user recover from a mistake?
7. Is the next step clear?
8. Does it work without accounting knowledge?
9. Does it remain usable when AI is unavailable?
10. Is it necessary for Version 1?

If a proposal fails several of these questions, it should be redesigned, deferred, or removed.

21. Design Deliverables Governed by This Blueprint

The following work should trace back to UX-0001:

- UX-0002 — Version 1 User Journey Map.
- UX-0003 — Information Architecture and Navigation Model.
- UX-0004 — Core Task Flows.
- UX-0005 — Low-Fidelity Wireframes.
- UX-0006 — AI Interaction and Explainability Specification.
- UX-0007 — Design System Foundations.
- UX-0008 — High-Fidelity MVP Prototype.
- UX-0009 — Accessibility Review.
- UX-0010 — Usability Test Plan and Findings.

When a later artifact conflicts with this blueprint, the conflict should be documented and resolved rather than silently implemented.

22. Recommended Immediate Next Step

The next design artifact should be UX-0002 — Version 1 User Journey Map.

It should map the complete experience for:

- First launch and trust establishment.
- Receipt capture.
- File or transaction import.
- Exception review.
- Search and retrieval.
- Correction and undo.
- Privacy and external AI consent.
- Error recovery.

The journey map should be completed before detailed wireframes. It will reveal where screens, states, decisions, and trust explanations are actually required.

Approval

UX-0001 is approved when Product, Design, Architecture, and Engineering agree that it accurately defines the intended Butlerly Version 1 experience and can be used to evaluate future product decisions.

BDS-0000 Conformance

BDS-0000 — Butler Design System v1.0 is the implementation authority for visual tokens, concrete theme values, typography, spacing/radius, responsive breakpoints, component/state behavior, accessibility implementation, localization/original-data presentation, and Flutter UI constraints. Finance V1 visible primary navigation is Home, Transactions, Review, Search, and Settings; Capture is global/contextual and Assistant is optional/non-primary. Core operation requires no Butlerly account. Device trust and synchronization are future/optional unless product scope explicitly enables them. UI-authored text follows the selected application language; user-entered/imported/scanned/source data preserves its original language and script by default. Original currency and amount remain authoritative; any reference-currency conversion is shown separately.